



RESOURCE PLAYBOOK

Data Governance Playbook

From Theory to Action: Transforming information chaos into strategic value

Sandy Bradbury

Lead Consultant | The Data Empowerment Journey

Specialized in the international DAMA framework

"Governance for People, Value from Data"

Capsule 1: Rules vs. Operations

Differentiating Data Governance from Data Management

Data Governance (The 'What' and 'Who')

Focus: Strategy, policies, procedures, security rules, responsibilities, and corporate authority.

Goal: Ensure data is used responsibly, ethically, and legally across the organization.

Data Management (The 'How')

Focus: Daily execution, technical architecture, storage, data models, and IT operations.

Goal: Ensure data is structured, protected, optimized, and accessible.

💡 **Golden Rule:** "Governance sets the rules of the game; Management ensures they are followed on the field."

Capsule 2: The Golden Square of Governance

The 4 Non-Negotiable Elements to Sustain Strategy

1. People

The engine of change. Data-driven culture, data literacy, and real operational adoption.

2. Processes

Standardized and regulated practices to keep information organized, trustworthy, and auditable.

3. Technology

Tools and architecture that enable efficiency, but depend 100% on human adoption.

4. Data

The core asset. Treated as a critical enterprise resource that must be accurate and accessible to generate value.

DAMA Maturity Alignment: Neglecting any of these four pillars destabilizes the entire strategic model and creates operational friction.

Capsule 3: Governed Data Democracy

From Restrictive Silos to Intelligent Accessibility

✗ The Past: Rigid Centralization

- Permanent operational bottlenecks in IT.
- Inaccessible information silos across departments.
- Centralized ownership that blocks agility.

✓ The Future: Governed Democracy

- **RBAC (Role-Based Access Control)**: Access based on context, roles, and business needs, not hierarchy.
- **Distributed Ownership**: Business domains manage their data under shared guardrails.

Real-World Success Case: Regional retail managers with real-time dashboards for agile inventory replenishment, operating autonomously within the corporate framework.



Capsule 4: Atomic Habits in Data Maturity

Continuous Improvement Systems vs. Massive Transformations

1. Start Small (MVP)

Solve one specific data quality issue at a time instead of trying to govern the entire company from day one.

2. Standardized Processes

Make governance happen "by default" through automated controls and metrics.

3. Regular Audits

Continually refine policies and controls based on real-world operational challenges.

4. Shared Responsibility

Turn information integrity into a daily habit for all employees across the business.



Capsule 5: Digital Hoarding Syndrome

Data Hygiene and Storage Optimization

The Problem: Storing data "just in case" skyrockets cloud storage costs and increases legal compliance risks (especially post-M&A or during privacy audits).

What We Purge: ROT Data

Redundant, Obsolete, Trivial: Duplicated records, legacy customer databases, and temporary files. Purged to reduce risk and optimize infrastructure.

What We Illuminate: Dark Data

Valuable Hidden Information: Unstructured data, sensor logs, or unanalyzed feedback. Classified and transformed into actionable intelligence.

Capsule 6: Data Literacy

The Bridge Between Raw Data and Profitable Decisions

Having dashboards does not mean being a *Data-Driven* company. True competitive advantage lies in your people's ability to interpret and challenge information.

1. Raw Data

The primary source of information housed in repositories, databases, and corporate systems.

2. The Bridge: Data Literacy

The organizational capability to read, understand, create, challenge, and communicate data in its business context.

3. Strategic Decisions

The final outcome: teams trust reports, correctly interpret metrics, and execute profitable actions.



Capsule 7: Measuring Financial ROI

Demonstrating the Economic Value of Data Governance

$$[\text{Quality KPIs}] \times [\text{Operational Impact}] = \text{FINANCIAL RETURN (ROI)}$$

1. Cost Reduction

Cloud storage optimization, ROT data purging, and elimination of wasted hours fixing manual errors.

2. Revenue Growth

Enabling advanced analytics and reliable Artificial Intelligence (*Garbage In, Garbage Out*).

3. Risk Mitigation

Preventing sensitive data leaks and safeguarding against regulatory fines (GDPR, LGPD, local privacy laws).



Capsule 8: The Integrated Ecosystem

From Theory to Action: The Ongoing Corporate Function

1. The Foundation

Rules (Capsule 1) + Golden Square (Capsule 2). Define the framework of accountability.

2. The Engine

Data Literacy (Capsule 6) + Governed Democracy (Capsule 3). Empower human talent.

3. The Operation

Atomic Habits (Capsule 4) + Digital Hoarding Clean-up (Capsule 5). Keep the system agile.

4. The Outcome

Measurable, Sustainable ROI and Enterprise Resilience (Capsule 7).



NEXT STEPS

Continue the Transformation

Do you know your organization's true maturity level?

1. Free Assessment

Complete the 25-question assessment in 5 minutes on our website.

2. Automated Diagnosis

Receive your instant executive report with your 5-pillar spider chart.

3. Strategic Session

Design your tailored roadmap alongside Sandy Bradbury.

The Data Empowerment Journey

Web: <https://dejourney.netlify.app/> | Email: san.bradbury@gmail.com

WhatsApp: +55 (11) 99200-4142 (Brazil) / +34 639 146 751 (Spain)